

long as it is useful. To take the information that we need without letting it permeate too deeply, without letting it stagnate as shame or fear. This is not something that I've been very good at in the past. Accepting criticism or bad outcomes without beating myself up is something that I've always found very difficult, and sometimes it's kept me locked in a cycle of not really trying hard enough and then being disappointed by the results. Because what if you give it your all and it's still not good enough? That's terrifying to me.

And yet we have to find a way to overcome that fear if we want to thrive, because when we tie our worth to external values and then panic about measuring up, all we do is limit our potential – and this applies just as much to money as it does to anything else. When we see certain cash values and figures as being associated with our intrinsic worth as a person, it can lead to an unhealthy obsession with accumulating wealth in order to try to increase our perceived value, or, alternatively, we can become stuck in a mindset of not pushing for what we deserve because we believe that our value is set at a certain point.

So, if not with a monetary value, how do we measure our worth? Well, my first question here is why do we feel the need to measure it at all? In fact, how could we possibly do it? As far as I'm aware, there's no unit of measurement that could possibly be adequate, so instead we have to find another way to think about things. Our value – whether as a friend, colleague, employee, contractor, romantic partner or family